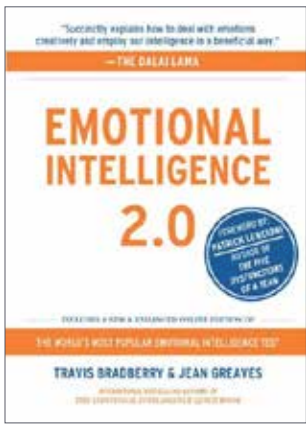




EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE 2.0

TRAVIS BRADBERRY & JEAN GREAVES

The Big “So What”



Emotional intelligence (EQ) has been widely proven to be an important factor of success. **This book explains what is EQ, how you can determine your EQ levels and use a step-by-step program (with 66 proven strategies) to improve 4 key EQ skills.**

Introduction



Most of us accept the importance of EQ, yet we don't give it much attention. Studies have found that EQ accounts for about 58% of performance in most jobs, and people with high EQ earn more than people with low EQ. Yet, based on the authors' tests, only 36% of people can identify their own emotions.



What is Emotional Intelligence (EQ)?



Our intelligence (IQ), EQ and personality jointly define how we think and act.

- Your EQ is your ability to identify and understand emotions in yourself and others, and to use this awareness to manage your responses and relationships.
- Your IQ affects your ability to learn, while your personality reflects your preferences and inclinations.
- All 3 qualities are relatively independent. Of the 3, EQ is the most flexible and it's easier to improve EQ than IQ or personality.

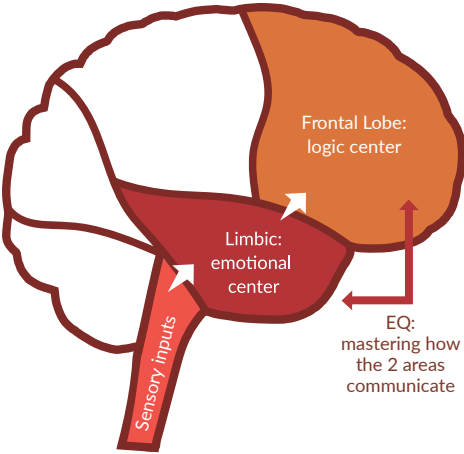
KEY QUOTES

“Emotional Intelligence 2.0 has one purpose—increasing your EQ.”

“We enter the workforce knowing how to read, write, and report on bodies of knowledge, but too often, we lack the skills to manage our emotions in the heat of the challenging problems we face.”



Humans are emotional creatures because of how we're wired biologically. Everything we perceive via our 5 senses travels through the body in the form of electric signals. These signals enter the brain at the base near the spinal cord and pass through your limbic system (where emotions are produced) before they reach the area where rational thinking takes place.



- That's why you experience things emotionally before logic kicks in, and may be overwhelmed by intense feelings like panic, sorrow, exuberance or outrage.
- However, there's a 2-way communication between the emotional and rational centers in your brain, and you can control the thoughts that follow the emotions. Practicing EQ skills help you to form and strengthen new neural connections in your brain which eventually form new habits.

KEY QUOTES

"Emotions can help you and they can hurt you, but you have no say in the matter until you understand them."

Understanding, Measuring & Improving EQ



An Emotional Intelligence Framework

In order to improve your EQ, you must know the skills involved and what they look like behaviorally. The authors present **4 key emotional intelligence skills**.

	 AWARENESS	 MANAGEMENT
 PERSONAL COMPETENCE	 Self Awareness Ability to identify & understand your feelings/tendencies	 Self Management Ability to adjust & direct your thoughts and actions
 SOCIAL COMPETENCE	 Social Awareness Ability to accurately pick up others' emotions & perspectives	 Relationship Management Ability to effectively manage interactions & relations

 Personal competence is your ability to be aware of your emotions and manage your reactions.

 Social competence is your ability to be aware of (and understand) others' moods, behavior and motives, and to manage your relationships well.



Developing a Specific Improvement Plan



Each book comes with a code for an Emotional Intelligence Appraisal® test. Use it to find your score (from 1-99) for each of the 4 EQ components, and identify specific areas for improvement.



Focus on only 1 EQ component at a time, to avoid diluting your focus and efforts. The test results will include a recommend of the skill to start with, though you can also pick your own area of focus.



Choose 3 strategies to begin with. Again, the test report will come with specific suggestions, but you are free to choose from the list of 66 strategies in the next section.



Find an EQ mentor (who is already strong in your chosen EQ skill), keep practicing and give yourself time to improve.



Measure/track your progress; when you feel you've made enough progress, retake the test and start the next cycle of improvement.

In the following sections, we'll elaborate on the 4 EQ dimensions and 66 proven strategies that you can use to improve your EQ.

Improving Self Awareness



Self awareness is simply knowing what makes you tick. It involves the ability to identify and understand your current emotions as well as your tendencies *across* situations.

KEY QUOTES

"As you transform yourself and bring new skills into your life, you'll reap all of the benefits that this incredible human ability has to offer."

"Self-awareness is not about discovering deep, dark secrets or unconscious motivations, but, rather, it comes from developing a straightforward and honest understanding of what makes you tick."

 With self awareness, you see how you react to events, challenges and people and understand why these emotions exist.

- When you can make sense of your feelings, you'll understand where you can excel, what motivates and fulfils you, and what type of people/situations may trigger certain feelings.
- This in turn allows you to pursue the right opportunities, apply your strengths optimally, and prevent emotions from holding you back from better performance.
- Self awareness lays the foundation for all the other EQ skills.

 Developing self awareness takes time. As you get in touch with your feelings, you'll uncover both positive and negative traits. Embrace all of them, and remember that being aware is already a step toward improvement.

Self Awareness Strategies

 Don't judge your feelings as good or bad—it only adds more emotions to the mix and prevents you from seeing the cause of the original feeling. Instead, pay attention when you feel an emotion surfacing, and seek to understand it without judgement.

 Observe the ripple effects of your emotional outbursts. Often, they continue to affect others even after the emotion has passed. Take note of how your emotions affect people, ask them for feedback, and consciously *choose* the types of ripples to create.

 Lean into your discomfort. Avoiding unpleasant emotions doesn't remove them and they'll keep resurfacing. Instead, face them and gradually work through them.

 Learn how an emotion physically affects you. Close your eyes, recall an intensely-emotional incident and notice the physical symptoms e.g. increased heart rate, stomach tightening, shallow breathing. With practice, you'd be able to identify your emotions via these symptoms faster than your brain can diagnose them logically.

KEY QUOTES

"Getting to know yourself inside and out is a continuous journey of peeling back the layers of the onion and becoming more and more comfortable with what is in the middle—the true essence of you."

"It's really the whole picture that serves us. The more we understand the beauty and the blemishes, the better we are able to achieve our full potential."

"Your outpouring of emotions are like stones that send ripples through the people in your life."

"Rather than avoiding a feeling, your goal should be to move toward the emotion, into it, and eventually through it."

"You'll find that you're often physically aware of an emotion long before you're mentally aware of it."

 **Know what triggers you.** Make a list of the exact people, situations, and environments that trigger certain emotions in you. When you know who/what triggers you and how exactly it irks you, you can learn to manage your responses.

 **Watch yourself like a hawk in the sky,** observing how your own emotions, thoughts and behaviors unfold in a situation. When you can see the big picture (including the other person's perspectives or how your emotional reactions may backfire), it's easier to calm down and formulate a more effective response.

 **Record your emotions in a journal,** noting the events/people that trigger strong feelings, the physical sensations you feel, and how you respond. Such entries help you to identify patterns in your emotions and how you tend to react. It also helps you to remember your fleeting responses and progress.

 **Don't be misled by bad moods.** A bad mood can cloud your judgment and make everything seem bad. Be aware when you're in a bad mood, reflect briefly on what may have caused it, and avoid making important decisions during this period.

 **Don't be deceived by good moods either.** Good moods can flood you with excitement and feelings that lead to impulsive actions. Enjoy your good moods but stay mindful of the consequences of your decisions.

 **Pause and question why you react the way you do.** When did you first react like this? Were you triggered by similar people or situations? The more you can identify the source of your emotions, the easier you can manage them.

 **Connect with your values.** We tend to get so caught up with our daily activities that we lose sight of our core values and beliefs. Revisit your values regularly (minimally once a month). Write down your values in 1 column, list down what you've done recently that you're not proud of in a 2 nd column, then identify what triggered those actions.

 **Check your physical appearance,** which often reflects how you feel. Regularly check your clothes, facial expressions, body language, etc., and notice how your mood affects your demeanor.

KEY QUOTES

"Knowing why your buttons are what they are opens doors to managing your reactions to your triggers."

"Once a negative mood takes over, you lose sight of what's good in your life."

"A good mood can deceive your thinking just as much as a bad one."

"The better you understand why you do the things you do, the better equipped you'll be to keep your emotions from running the show."



Use art as a reflection of yourself. Consider the books, movies, and music which you resonate with—what grabs your attention and why? Artists can often express complex feelings which we can't; you can deepen self-awareness by finding your emotions in their work.



Seek others' feedback to identify the gaps between how you see yourself and how others see you. Get feedback for specific situations and put the various viewpoints together to see a bigger picture.



Know when you're stressed. People react differently to stress (e.g. loss of sleep, headache, back spasms). Identify your physical/emotional responses to stress so you can recharge before the stress escalates.

Improving Self Management



Self management is your ability to use your emotional awareness to deliberately choose what you say and do. It enables you to adjust and direct your responses to people and circumstances in a positive way.



It allows you to rein your emotions in, decide whether to take action and the type of action to take, such as overcoming your paralysis from fear, or stopping yourself from lashing out in anger.



It also involves your ability to set aside your immediate needs to focus on longer-term goals. People who're strong in self-management handle stressful situations and confrontations more effectively, communicate better, and are proactive yet patient.



Self Management Strategies



Breathe right. Oxygen goes first to your body's vital functions, then to the complex functions that keep you calm and focused. Shallow breathing leads to lower energy levels and concentration, reducing your ability to self-manage. When you're stressed, take slow deep breaths via your nose then exhale gently and fully from your mouth.

KEY QUOTES

"By mustering the courage to peer at what others see, you can reach a level of self-awareness that few people attain."

"Success comes to those who can put their needs on hold and continually manage their tendencies."



Use an Emotions-vs-Logic list when your head and heart are in conflict. Write down the list of emotional vs logical arguments in 2 columns, side by side. Then ask 2 questions: (a) where could emotions be clouding your judgment? and (b) where could logic be blocking emotional cues? Write these down so you can see the situation more clearly.



Share your goals publicly to motivate yourself to take action. You can even ask someone to specifically hold you accountable and dish out rewards or punishments.



Count to 10. When you sense yourself becoming frustrated or angry, count to 10, taking a deep breath with each count. This will help you to calm down and re-engage your rational brain.



Let things settle. If you're stuck, sleep on the problem, so the dust can settle and emotions can run their course, before making a decision. Time brings clarity and perspective.



Consult a role model. Ask someone skilled in self-management for advice. Ensure you follow-up on the tips.



Smile and laugh. The nerves and muscles in your face send signals to your brain that set your emotional state. To break a negative mood, read/watch something funny, force yourself to smile, or hold a pencil between your teeth to activate the muscles used in smiling.



Set aside 15mins a day for problem-solving. Put away your phone and computer; dedicate this time to thinking without distractions.



Manage your self-talk. An average person has about 50,000 thoughts per day, and such thoughts trigger chemical reactions in the body that affect your emotions and behaviors. Catch yourself with negative thoughts (e.g. "I'm an idiot", "it's all their fault") and replace them with healthier thoughts (e.g. "I fumbled this once", "we can learn from this").



Visualize success. Your brain reacts the same way when you're visualizing something and when you actually experience it. Each night, before going to bed, visualize yourself effectively managing your emotions and acting the desired way. These mental practices help to prepare you for challenging situations.

KEY QUOTES

"Much of self-management comes down to motivation, and you can use the expectations that other people have of you as a powerful force to get you up off the proverbial couch."

"Force yourself to wait for the dust to settle before you make a move."

"There is a strong relationship between what you think and how you feel, both physically and emotionally."



Improve your sleep hygiene. To feel fresh, alert and balanced, you need enough quality sleep, which in turn requires good sleep hygiene. Reset your biological clock with 20min of natural morning sunlight daily, avoid caffeine after noon, avoid working or watching TV in bed, and avoid screens 2 hours before bedtime (as blue light hinders production of hormones needed for sleep).



Focus on freedoms, not limitations. In any situation, you can *always* choose your perspectives. Take accountability for areas within your control (e.g. your attitudes and reactions), instead of fretting about things beyond your control.



Stay synchronized, i.e. check that your body language and emotions are in sync. When your emotions threaten to get the best of you, focus on the task at hand instead of the feelings.



Find an objective sounding board to get fresh perspectives on a problem. Speak with someone you trust who's not emotionally invested in the problem, and who won't blindly agree with you.



Learn from everyone you meet. When you're upset or defensive, you feel stressed and tend to miss out on learning opportunities. By seeking to learn from every interaction (be it about yourself or others), you'll feel more relaxed and open-minded.



Recharge mentally. Schedule time for physical activity; this gives your brain some rest, releases chemicals to improve your mood, keeps you alert, and increases your productivity and effectiveness.



Anticipate change. You can't predict the future. The best way to be prepared is to expect change. Set aside some time weekly/ fortnightly to consider potential changes and actions, so you won't be caught by surprise when they happen.

KEY QUOTES

"Even when you can't do or say anything to change a difficult situation, you always have a say in your perspective of what's happening."

"Approaching everyone you encounter as though they have something valuable to teach you...is the best way to remain flexible, open-minded and much less stressed."

"The key to navigating change successfully is your perspective before changes even surface."

Improving Social Awareness



Social awareness is your ability to accurately tune in to others' emotions and understand what's really going on with them. This requires the willingness and ability to understand others' perspectives even if they differ from yours.



We tend to get so caught up in our own thoughts or emotions that we don't truly consider the other person's point of view.



To build social awareness, we must be fully present, listen and observe. This means we must silence our self-talk, stop anticipating what the other person may say, and give him/her our full attention.



Social Awareness Strategies



Use and remember people's names. When you're introduced to someone, greet him by his name, picture the name spelt out (or ask how it's spelt), and use it at least twice in your first conversation, so you'd remember the name.



Observe body language, and learn to recognize subtle emotional cues which convey lots of information. Notice if the person maintains eye contact, appears relaxed or fidgety etc.



Pick the right timing. Focus on the other person's emotional state, so you can match your question/message with the right timing and frame of mind. For example, avoid asking for favors when someone is clearly upset.



Have a back-pocket question that you can use if a conversation dies out, the other person is closing up, or you run out of things to say. A question like "What do you think about [add a topic]" can help to revive the conversation.



Focus on people at meetings, not note-taking. We tend to be so focused on taking notes at meetings that we miss out vital nonverbal communications. If possible, focus on listening or watching others at meetings rather than taking notes. Or, at

KEY QUOTES

"To be socially aware, you have to spot and understand people's emotions while you're right there in the middle of it—a contributing, yet astutely aware, member of the interaction."

"Listening and observing are the most important elements of social awareness."

"The body communicates nonstop and is an abundant source of information."

"When dealing with people and their emotions, timing really is everything."

least pause your note-taking regularly to observe people's body language (e.g. facial expressions, who's making eye contact with whom).



Plan ahead for social events, e.g. list down who'll be attending, the talking points you want to use, or things you must bring or accomplish. This frees up your mind at the event to focus fully on the people there.



Remove mental clutter. When someone is speaking, don't interrupt. Stop the internal chatter in your head and avoid formulating your responses as they speak. Instead of trying to impress the other person, focus on learning something from the conversation.



Be fully present in the moment; don't constantly live in past regrets or worries about the future.



Do a 15min walkabout every workday to observe people. Look at people's workspaces, how they interact with one another, and try to pick up their moods and other social clues.



Learn EQ from movies. Movies often reflect real life. Watch 2 movies this month just to observe the characters' emotional cues, body language, relationships, interactions, etc. Notice how conflict builds up and how the characters handle conflict.



Practice listening. Most people think they're great listeners when they're not. Listen not just for the words, but also the tone of voice, hidden meanings and what's left unsaid. This requires focus.



Go people-watching in a public place, e.g. a coffee shop or grocery store. Watch how people reveal their moods/feelings and interact with one another.



Identify cultural rules. We live in a melting pot of various cultures, each with its own set of rules and norms. To succeed in a new environment (e.g. a new workplace), you need to learn its culture. This requires listening, observing and interacting with people over a period of time. Ask specific questions to learn what's acceptable and unacceptable to them.

KEY QUOTES

"To be socially aware, you must be socially present and remove distractions—especially the ones inside your head."

"Watching movies from the land of make-believe is one of the most useful and entertaining ways to practice your social awareness skills for the real world."

"Listening isn't just about hearing words; it's also about listening to the tone, speed, and volume of the voice."

"The secret to winning this cultural game is to treat others how they want to be treated, not how you would want to be treated."

 **Check for accuracy.** If you're unsure about a cue, you can confirm your interpretation by asking a reflective question. State what you see then ask a direct question, e.g. "You seem sad...Did something happen?"

 **Put yourself in their shoes.** The best way to understand someone is to try to see things from their perspective. Ask yourself, "If I were this person, how would I feel, act, or respond?". Think about how the person has reacted in similar situations and if possible, check with them to verify your guesses.

 **Assemble the whole picture.** There's usually a gap between how we see ourselves and how others see us, e.g. your attempt to be proactive may be perceived to be bossiness. Get feedback or do a 360-degree survey to understand what people perceive.

 **Read the room.** Once you're familiar with reading cues and emotions of individuals, you can try reading the mood of an entire room. Try sensing the energy level and mood, observing how people arrange themselves or behave. Or, get someone with high social awareness to share his observations with you.

Improving Relationship Management



Relationship management is your ability to apply the emotional awareness of yourself and others to manage your relations. This includes effective communication, conflict management and forging bonds. Such skills are the most useful during times of stress or conflict, when people either (a) give in to their anger/frustration, or (b) avoid the conflict and let it fester because they don't know how to handle it.



Relationship Management Strategies

 **Be open and interested.** Be open to share about yourself so others can understand you. Be genuinely interested about others and ask questions to learn about their perspectives.

KEY QUOTES

"Walking in the shoes of another is social awareness at its best."

"Believe it or not, what others say about you is usually more accurate than what you think about yourself."

"Working on a relationship takes time, effort and knowhow. The know-how is emotional intelligence."



Augment your natural style. Write down a description of your natural communication style, then list down the positives vs negatives of this style in 2 columns. Choose 3 upsides to use more and 3 downsides to eliminate/improve. Ask your friends, family or colleagues to help you with the list.



Stop giving mixed signals. Be aware when your body language conveys a different message from your words. If you know you're giving mixed signals, explain why e.g. you're still upset over an earlier incident and not over the current conversation.



Remember: small things matter. Small courtesies like saying "please", "thank you" and "I'm sorry" can make a big difference in your relationships.



Receive feedback well. We may respond poorly to feedback if we feel offended or are taken by surprise. Listen carefully, ask for examples of what you said/did to create the impression, and always thank the person for the feedback. Then, use the other strategies to evaluate the feedback and decide what to do with it.



Build trust by opening up first, being consistent in your words, actions and behaviors over time, and fulfilling your promises. Strong relations require mutual trust, which can only be built with time and deliberate effort.



Be as accessible as you can, while realizing that you cannot be available for everyone at all times.



Master your anger. Anger exists for a reason; the challenge is to use it purposefully rather than let it control you. Express your anger appropriately to show the seriousness of a situation or to improve a relationship.



Face the inevitable. When you face an unpleasant situation, don't withdraw or try to avoid it. Instead, find ways to handle or improve the situation. For example, if you must work with someone you dislike, apply your EQ skills to establish mutual understanding, and/or put boundaries in place to make your interaction more constructive for both sides.

KEY QUOTES

"People trust what they see over what they hear."

"Trust is something that takes time to build, can be lost in seconds, and may be our most important and difficult objective in managing our relationships."

*"Anyone can become angry—that is easy. But to be angry with the right person, to the right degree, at the right time, for the right purpose, and in the right way, this is not easy."
- Aristotle*



Respect and recognize others' feelings, regardless of whether you agree with them. Don't dismiss or try to change these feelings. Listen carefully and summarize what you've heard to show your understanding and concern.



Complement people's emotions or situations. Mirroring someone's emotions may backfire if the person is upset. Instead, identify the person's emotional state and respond in a complementary way. For instance, if someone is asking for help, you may respond in a friendly/relaxed way if he seems calm, but take a serious/urgent tone if he seems agitated.



Show you care. Don't hesitate to show others you notice and appreciate their good work, with a thank you note, small gift, etc.



Explain your decisions. To support a decision, people must understand it. Seek inputs if possible, help people to understand your decision process, the alternatives considered and why the final choice was made. Address how the decision will affect everyone.



Give direct and constructive feedback. Always consider the person who's receiving the feedback and adapt your approach so it'll be clear, constructive, and respectful to him/her. Share your observations, offer solutions, ask the person to share his/her views and thank the person for considering your suggestions.



Align intent with words and actions. Think of the times when you unintentionally caused hard feelings or strained a relationship. Write down your intentions, actions, and others' reactions. Then, analyze what you've learned on hindsight (e.g. cues you missed, varying perspectives) and identify what you can do differently in future.



Fix a broken conversation. When you realize a conversation is deteriorating, focus on restoring communication by saying something neutral like, "This is hard," or "How are you feeling?". This allows both sides to pause and get the interaction back on-track.

KEY QUOTES

"Everyone has a right to experience feelings, even if you might not feel the same way."

"There are people who do great work around you every day. When you care, show it."

"Remember, feedback is meant to address the problem, not the person...Constructive feedback has two parts: sharing your opinion and offering solutions for change."

"Let go of blame and focus on the repair. Do you want to be right, or do you want a resolution?"



Tackle tough conversations, which will come up no matter how high your EQ is. Use this 6-part approach to manage them:

- Start by stating the common ground that you share.
- Ask the other person to share his/her point of view.
- Listen first. Resist the urge to defend your point of view.
- Help the other person to understand your point of view (your logic, feelings, dilemmas etc.).
- Move the conversation forward, e.g. “I’m glad we’ve had the opportunity to talk. I understand your views, and you seem to understand mine. I’m still committed to make this project a success. What are your thoughts?”.
- After the meeting, keep in touch with the person to see how he/she is doing.

KEY QUOTES